10 energy-saving cooking habits

Piccoli gesti, grande differenza

Simple habits that use less gas or electricity every day, whatever kind of hob you have.

1 Put a lid on it

A covered pot boils sooner and simmers on a lower heat.

2 Match pan to ring

A small pan on a big flame wastes the heat that goes round it.

3 Only the water you need

Boil just enough water for the pasta or vegetables.

4 Use leftover heat

Switch off a few minutes early; food keeps cooking.

5 Batch cook

One big pot of ragù or beans, frozen in portions, saves many cookings.

6 Fill the oven

Roast vegetables or bake bread while the oven is on anyway.

7 Low-energy pasta

Boil 2 minutes, cover, switch off and let it finish in the hot water.

8 Soak beans overnight

Soaked beans cook in much less time.

9 Kettle for boiling

Boil water in the kettle, then pour it into the pan.

10 Waste nothing

Leftovers become new meals, so the energy used to grow and cook them is not wasted.